

Speaker 2 [00:00:04] Okay. Can I turn off my camera? I don't like the idea of having my face in the recording.

Speaker 2 [00:00:29] Okay, I think I would feel more comfortable talking.

Speaker 2 [00:00:44] Alright. I've turned off my camera.

Speaker 2 [00:01:11] Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:01:20] No problem.

Speaker 2 [00:01:25] [25-30].

Speaker 2 [00:01:32] About [0-5] years.

Speaker 2 [00:01:37] [City 1].

Speaker 2 [00:01:45] I live alone. I also go back and forth between my mom's place and my own home. I spend half of the week with my mom and the other half at my place.

Speaker 2 [00:02:02] I currently work at a company. I'm a [occupation].

Speaker 2 [00:02:16] We can say sevgili.

Speaker 2 [00:02:27] About [0-5] years ago, I was living in a student house with two friends. My current sevgili was a close friend of one of my roommates. He spent a lot of time at our place and often stayed over. That's how we met.

Speaker 2 [00:03:02] Among my friends, there aren't many who are in relationships. I can't say all my friends are in relationships, but compared to those around me, I think we have a healthy relationship. I'm not saying we're a better couple, but I think we're in a good place.

Speaker 2 [00:03:33] Sure. Our communication is very strong. We are very focused on resolving our issues directly. We don't give each other the silent treatment, stay mad, take breaks, or break up. When we have a disagreement, which sometimes turns into a fight, we usually resolve it in about half an hour. We never stay mad at each other. Of course, we have unresolved issues from the past, but generally, we solve problems when they arise. I see many people around me who prefer not to resolve their issues or try to appease each other in other ways. We try to communicate more, and that's why I think we're in a good place.

Speaker 2 [00:05:00] I've had many minor and a few major relationships before, but I've had [1-5] other relationships that lasted more than [1-5] year.

Speaker 2 [00:05:20] In my previous relationships, I was younger and didn't fully understand what kind of person I wanted to be with. I was in those relationships genuinely, but looking back, those relationships lacked the depth that my current relationship has. The connections were

more superficial, based on things like having the same hobbies or spending a lot of time in the same social circles. In my current relationship, we connect on more important topics like future plans and values. That's why this relationship feels better for me.

Speaker 2 [00:06:29] That's a good question. What makes a relationship high-quality and meaningful? I think feeling loved and important. In past relationships, I sometimes felt worthless or not valued, but stayed in the relationship anyway. I think what makes a relationship good is feeling loved and important, being the most special person to someone.

Speaker 2 [00:07:20] What makes a relationship low-quality? I think it's the opposite of what I just said. Feeling worthless in the relationship, not being valued enough by the other person, or even being belittled can make a relationship very bad.

Speaker 2 [00:08:00] Yes. uh-huh.

Speaker 2 [00:08:24] Actually, it's similar to our friendships. The people who understand us best and speak our language are the ones who make us feel most loved. Loving someone means knowing them very well and loving all their aspects. The more the person in front of me makes me feel that they know me well, the more I feel loved. I can't be convinced that someone loves me if they don't really know me.

Speaker 2 [00:09:22] Are you talking about my current relationship? My boyfriend went out of town, and he brought me a gift when he returned. I really liked the gift because it was exactly what I wanted and suited me perfectly. That made me feel very good.

Speaker 2 [00:09:51] What do you mean by the most important things in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:10:14] I see. I think the most important things in a relationship are being able to spend time together without thinking too much about it. I'm quite asocial in my personal life and usually find it difficult to spend time with people, but with my boyfriend, I don't feel any stress. Whether we talk, watch TV, or just sit in different corners of the room, the important thing is spending time together peacefully. Another important thing is creating special moments or spaces for each other. Simple gestures like going out for dinner, giving gifts, or planning vacations make the relationship healthier.

Speaker 2 [00:12:09] What is aşk to me? I used to think aşk was like an obsession. In high school, I was very much in love with a friend and believed that was aşk, even though it was one-sided. Now, after several relationships, I've realized that aşk is something created together. At the beginning of a relationship, there's excitement and passion, but maintaining that in a healthy way transforms it into aşk. It's about mutual effort and creating something beautiful together.

Speaker 1 [00:13:46] How do you know your partner loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:13:52] Like I mentioned before, if my partner knows me well, I know he loves me. This shows in how he handles my emotions, like when I'm angry or stressed, and how he plans special occasions for me.

Speaker 1 [00:14:28] How important is aşk in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:14:32] I think aşk is very important. Without aşk, I feel like I couldn't be in a relationship. While some middle-aged couples might not have aşk but still stay together, I currently can't imagine being with someone without aşk.

Speaker 1 [00:15:07] Can you talk about the challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:15:13] One challenge is that I'm quite asocial and prefer staying at home, while my boyfriend is very social and adventurous. He wants to go out, but I usually don't. Another challenge was when we lived together; we had issues related to cleanliness and household chores. He often had guests over, which I didn't always like. Oh, someone's at the door. I'll be back in five minutes.

Speaker 2 [00:17:00] I'm back. So, as I was saying, [redacted]. Over time, I realized that some things don't change, and I had to decide if I could tolerate those traits. Currently, I think the positive aspects of the relationship outweigh the negatives. Although there are things I don't like, they are not major issues for me right now.

Speaker 1 [00:18:16] Do you and your partner argue?

Speaker 2 [00:18:23] We've had a few loud arguments, maybe two or three times, but not very often. Usually, we have smaller disagreements. There have been bigger fights, but not frequently.

Speaker 1 [00:18:44] What are these fights about?

Speaker 2 [00:18:56] Can I skip this question? I'm not very comfortable answering it.

Speaker 1 [00:19:06] That's fine. How do you resolve these fights?

Speaker 2 [00:19:11] As I mentioned earlier, most of our fights are about long-standing issues. We usually discuss how to solve them and take steps towards a resolution. However, since we don't always follow through, these issues resurface periodically.

Speaker 1 [00:20:17] Besides resolving fights, what are other ways to maintain your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:20:25] We love traveling. We often go places together, even within [city 2]. It helps us relax and enjoy each other's company. Not everyone enjoys the same type of vacation, but we generally agree on travel plans.

Speaker 1 [00:20:59] So, by traveling?

Speaker 2 [00:21:00] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:21:07] Do you think this relationship is good for you?

Speaker 2 [00:21:08] Yes, I do.

Speaker 1 [00:21:09] Why?

Speaker 2 [00:21:14] Because my boyfriend is like a safety net for me. I know that no matter what happens, I have someone to rely on. I try to provide the same support for him. Even if we achieve nothing else in life, at least we have each other. That's why this relationship is good for me. That makes me feel very secure.

Speaker 1 [00:21:49] Has this relationship changed you?

Speaker 2 [00:21:54] Yes, it has changed me a lot.

Speaker 1 [00:21:55] How?

Speaker 2 [00:22:10] It has changed my perspective on relationships. This is my longest relationship, and it's different from my previous ones. I've learned how to maintain a long-term relationship, balancing what to sacrifice and what to gain. I'm naturally a homebody, but my boyfriend is more outgoing, and he has helped me become more adventurous and social.

Speaker 1 [00:23:00] Has your partner changed during this relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:23:05] Yes, he has. When we started dating, he didn't have a career plan. He had dropped out of university and was just going with the flow. But with my influence, he started focusing on his goals and turned them into a career plan. That's the biggest change I've seen in him.

Speaker 1 [00:24:03] Is your partner the same as he was before the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:24:14] We've both changed, of course. We've grown and developed independently of the relationship as well. But I still see the person I fell in love with [0-5] years ago in him.

Speaker 1 [00:24:55] Do you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:24:59] Yes, I do.

Speaker 1 [00:25:01] Can you elaborate on why you feel this way?

Speaker 2 [00:25:08] As I mentioned earlier, I know my partner will do everything he can to support me, solve my problems, get me out of the situation if something happens to me, and make me feel better if something goes wrong. That's why I feel safe.

Speaker 1 [00:25:38] Can you give a concrete example of this?

Speaker 2 [00:25:45] A concrete example? Like a specific incident where he helped me?

Speaker 1 [00:25:52] Exactly.

Speaker 2 [00:25:07] I need to think about it. I can't think of a specific example right now, unfortunately.

Speaker 1 [00:26:19] I will show you a paper with questions on it. If you can't read it, that's okay, I will read them out loud.

Speaker 2 [00:26:26] Alright.

Speaker 1 [00:26:28] I'm showing you the paper now. Can you see it?

Speaker 2 [00:26:32] No, it's blurry because of the background.

Speaker 1 [00:26:41] I will read the question now: My partner generally listens to me. On a scale from 1 to 9, with 1 being not at all and 9 being completely true, how would you rate this?

Speaker 2 [00:26:49] Can you repeat the question?

Speaker 1 [00:26:58] My partner generally listens to me.

Speaker 2 [00:27:01] 9.

Speaker 1 [00:27:05] What about this: My partner is generally sensitive to my needs?

Speaker 2 [00:27:14] Umm, 8.

Speaker 1 [00:27:15] You gave a 9 for my partner generally listens to me. Can you give a concrete example of when this happened?

Speaker 2 [00:27:34] Well, it's not a specific example, but every time we talk, he listens to my concerns and responds accordingly. He never dismisses me, so I know he really listens.

Speaker 1 [00:28:09] For the second question, you rated 8 for my partner is generally sensitive to my needs. Why 8 and not 7 or 9?

Speaker 2 [00:28:20] I wanted to say 9 because he is sensitive to my needs. But then I thought there might be times when he wasn't as sensitive, so I couldn't be 100% sure. If he wasn't sensitive, it was likely because he didn't realize my situation, not because he didn't care.

Speaker 1 [00:28:54] I hope this isn't too sensitive for you to share. If it is, please don't hesitate to tell me. But I want to learn more about your physical intimacy as a couple. How often do you have sexual relations these days?

Speaker 2 [00:29:14] Let me think. We see each other [1-5] times a week, so I would say about [1-5] times a week.

Speaker 1 [00:29:28] How satisfied are you with your sex life?

Speaker 2 [00:29:34] I would say 7 out of 10. It could definitely be better, and we both know that. But I would give it a 7.

Speaker 1 [00:29:47] Why do you think that?

Speaker 2 [00:29:50] It's become routine, like in many long-term relationships. Various life events and moods affect us. We go through phases where it's very good for a few months, then quieter for the next few months. Right now, it's very routine, and that can reduce the desire. It's like knowing the end of a movie, so it could be better.

Speaker 1 [00:30:42] Overall, how satisfied are you with your relationship? I'll read the options: completely dissatisfied to completely satisfied. What would you rate it?

Speaker 2 [00:31:05] Is it from 1 to 9 again?

Speaker 2 [00:31:09] 7.

Speaker 2 [00:31:11] From 1 to 7, can I say five and a half? Half points?

Speaker 1 [00:31:22] No halves, only whole numbers.

Speaker 2 [00:31:26] Then I'll say six.

Speaker 1 [00:31:30] So, very satisfied.

Speaker 2 [00:31:33] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:31:38] If we think in terms of completely dissatisfied to completely satisfied, what would you rate it?

Speaker 2 [00:31:53] I think I would give it an 8.

Speaker 1 [00:31:56] Why 8 and not 9 or 7?

Speaker 2 [00:32:13] I would never give it a 10, as that's too unrealistic. I could say 9 instead of 8, but 7 seems too low. Recently, I've had some doubts, which brought my rating down a bit. I have some future concerns that I have shared with my partner. If I were more certain, I would say 9, but currently, I'm not.

Speaker 1 [00:33:05] Does your relationship meet your expectations?

Speaker 2 [00:33:12] Yes, it does.

Speaker 1 [00:33:17] Can you elaborate on that?

Speaker 2 [00:33:18] In my life, having someone to be with is very important. Without a partner, I tend to feel more unhappy and dissatisfied. I always want to be with someone. So, I have certain expectations from my partner, like feeling loved and special, spending a lot of time together without getting bored, and having someone who both comforts me and pushes me out of my comfort zone, makes me social. This relationship meets those expectations.

Speaker 1 [00:35:02] We've talked a lot, so I want to summarize. You met [0-5] years ago in a student house. You think your communication is good and healthy. He makes you feel special and knows what you want, makes you feel loved. You have occasional arguments but try to resolve long-standing issues. He helps you get out of your comfort zone and become more social. You believe the relationship has positively changed both of you. Is there anything else you would like to add?

Speaker 2 [00:36:25] Let me think. The only thing I want to add is that, despite having some doubts, this interview made me realize the importance of my relationship. It wasn't as negative as I expected. Despite my concerns, I believe I'm in a good relationship. This interview has helped me understand that better.

Speaker 1 [00:37:20] I want to be as transparent as possible. We can share the interview details without identifiable information. If you're comfortable, we can share more detailed excerpts anonymized but still meaningful. Which option do you prefer?

Speaker 2 [00:38:27] As long as details like how we met and age information are removed, the full transcript can be shared. I didn't give any sensitive information, so it's fine with me. Just don't share that specific information.

Speaker 1 [00:38:45] We can remove those details and share the full transcript. The second option.

Speaker 1 [00:38:49] Yes, names won't be included anyway.

Speaker 1 [00:38:53] Okay, thank you very much for participating in the interview.

Speaker 2 [00:39:09] You're welcome.